

The organisation did not have a level problem — it had a distribution problem.

Headcount ratios would have called this supply-chain function efficient. Assessing workload role by role showed something more useful: a lean structure carrying peer-topping spend per person, with no headroom left for the growth it was being asked to absorb.

INDUSTRY	ENGAGEMENT CONTEXT	ROLE	DURATION
Energy & utilities — regulated electric & gas	Consulting · US energy utility	Organisational benchmarking & operating-model assessment	12 weeks

THE SITUATION

- Leadership needed to know whether the supply-chain organisation was structured to support current spend and planned growth.
- Raw headcount comparisons risked obscuring real differences in role scope and functional coverage between peers.
- The objective was a fact base for workforce and operating-model decisions, not a headcount verdict in either direction.

MY CONTRIBUTION

I led the benchmarking assessment across structure, role allocation and functional capacity — defining the peer-comparison framework, normalising spend and headcount by workload, clustering roles by capability rather than title, reviewing coverage across sourcing, procurement operations, PMO/CoE and planning, and translating the findings into structural implications.

THE JUDGMENT THAT MATTERED

High spend per person can mean a lean organisation or an overloaded one, and the two call for opposite responses. Reading the number alongside scope, service expectations and how execution work was distributed is what turned a benchmark into a recommendation rather than a headline.

WHAT THE WORK DELIVERED

- A structured fact base on supply-chain sizing relative to peers, usable directly in workforce planning.
- Lean enablement and the absence of a standalone planning function identified as the two structural gaps.

EXHIBIT 1 Spend supported per FTE against peer utilities

Peer distribution shown as a box plot · indexed · directional

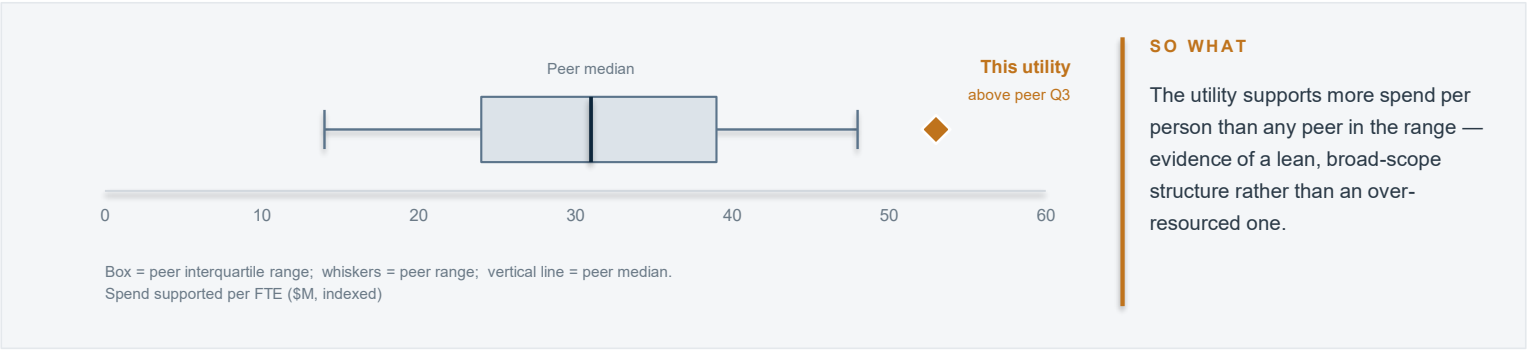
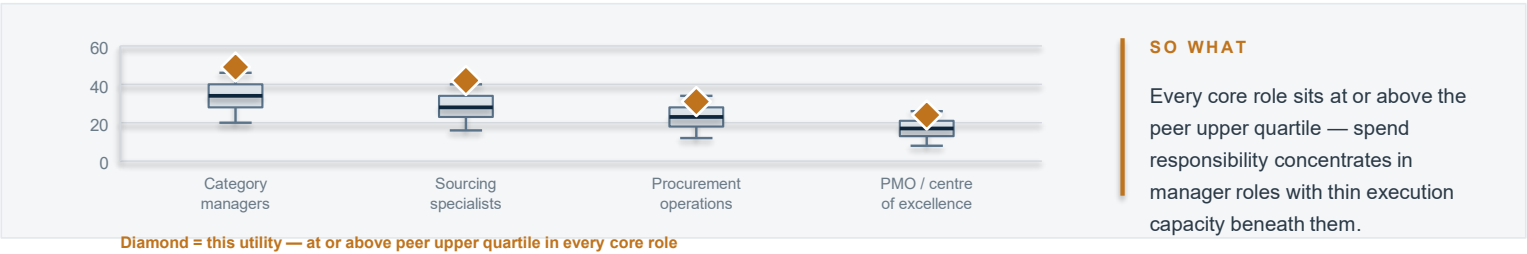


EXHIBIT 2 Spend supported per FTE, by role

Each box = peer distribution · diamond = this utility · directional



HEADLINE

Role by role

supply-chain capacity assessed